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CUSTOMIZATION IN FASHION DESIGNING: A COMPREHENSIVE STUDY OF BUYER AND SELLER PERSPECTIVES

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ABSTRACT:

The fashion industry has changed a lot in the few years. It used to be about making lots of the same clothes but now it is more about making clothes that are special for each person. This is because fashion design is now all about customisation. Customisation in fashion design means that customers can help make clothes that show who they are and what they like. This study looks at what sellers do and how customers behave when it comes to customisation in fashion design. The study tries to figure out why people like clothes that are made for them. Some people like customised clothes because they fit better or because they can show off their style. Others like them because they make them feel good about themselves.. Customised clothes can also be expensive and take a long time to make which can be frustrating for customers. The study also looks at how companies can make customisation work for them. Companies need to change how they market and sell their clothes if they want to offer customisation. To find out more the study used a questionnaire to ask people in cities between the ages of 18 and 35 what they thought about customisation. The study also looked at what other researchers and experts have said about customisation. The results show that customisation is good for companies because it makes customers happy and loyal to the brand.. It can also be expensive and complicated for companies to offer customisation. Customisation in fashion design is a deal and it can be good, for fashion design companies. Fashion design companies need to think about how they can use customisation to make their customers happy.

Keywords: *Fashion Customisation, Personalised Clothing, Consumer Behaviour, Customer Preferences, Customer Satisfaction, Brand Loyalty, Fashion Marketing, Self-Expression, Consumer Buying Behaviour, Fashion Industry.*

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The fashion industry has traditionally operated on a mass production model, where garments are designed based on predicted trends and produced in large quantities for a broad audience. Although this strategy guarantees effectiveness and cost savings it often does not meet the needs of some customers. Many modern consumers are unhappy with sizes, limited design choices and lack of creativity.

The rapid growth of technology, social media and globalisation has greatly changed how people shop. Todays consumers are more aware, expressive and care about fashion. They do not just follow trends; they look for products that show their personality. As a result customisation in fashion design has become very important.

Customisation lets customers change a garments fabric, colour, fit and design among things. This approach makes the customer an active part of the design process, not a passive buyer. Advances in technology, such as intelligence, computer-aided design and virtual try-on systems have made this change possible.

Customisation represents a shift in business strategy from focusing on products to focusing on customers. It brings challenges like managing production complexity controlling costs and maintaining supply chain efficiency. However it also offers opportunities, for standing out and increasing customer engagement.

1.2 Research Problem

Despite its growing popularity, customization in fashion designing presents several challenges for both consumers and businesses. Consumers often face issues such as higher costs, longer waiting periods, and difficulty in making design decisions due to the availability of numerous options. On the other hand, businesses must deal with increased operational complexity, higher production costs, and the need for technological integration.

Another major issue is the lack of comprehensive research that simultaneously examines both buyer and seller perspectives. Most studies focus on either consumer behavior or business strategies, leaving a gap in understanding the interaction between the two.

Therefore, the central research problem is:

To analyze how customization influences consumer behavior and how fashion businesses respond strategically while addressing associated challenges.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The main objectives of this study are:

- To examine consumer preferences for customized fashion products
- To identify factors influencing purchasing decisions
- To analyze the impact of customization on customer satisfaction and loyalty
- To study challenges faced by consumers and businesses
- To evaluate strategies adopted by fashion brands for customization

1.4 Scope and Importance of the Study

This study focuses on urban consumers aged 18–35 and small to medium fashion businesses. It is significant because it provides insights into evolving consumer behavior and helps businesses design effective customization strategies. It also contributes to academic research by bridging the gap between buyer and seller perspectives.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW AND RESEARCH GAP

2.1 Literature Review

Previous studies highlight that customization enhances customer satisfaction by creating emotional attachment and a sense of ownership. The concept of mass customization has enabled businesses to offer personalized products at scale using advanced technology.

Research also shows that factors such as perceived value, ease of use, and enjoyment influence consumer attitudes toward customization. From a business perspective, customization serves as a differentiation strategy but requires significant investment in technology and skilled labor.

2.2 Research Gap

The study identifies the following gaps:

- Lack of integrated research combining buyer and seller perspectives
- Limited focus on emerging markets like India
- Insufficient practical insights for small-scale designers

3. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

The study adopts a descriptive and analytical research design. It combines quantitative analysis with interpretation to understand consumer behavior and business strategies.

3.2 Sources of Data

- **Primary Data:** Questionnaire responses from 100 participants
- **Secondary Data:** Journals, articles, industry reports

3.3 Sampling Design

- Method: Convenience sampling
- Sample size: 100
- Age group: 18–35

3.4 Data Collection Tool

A structured questionnaire covering:

- Demographics
- Awareness
- Preferences
- Motivation
- Challenges
- Satisfaction

3.5 Limitations

- Limited sample size

- Urban-focused data
- Possible response bias

4. DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 Awareness and Preference

Approximately 75–80% of respondents are aware of customization, indicating its growing popularity. Around 75% prefer customized clothing, especially for special occasions.

4.2 Reasons for Customization

- Better Fit (40%)
- Uniqueness (30%)
- Self-expression (20%)
- Social influence (10%)

4.3 Willingness to Pay

60% of respondents are willing to pay extra for customized products, showing that customization is perceived as premium.

4.4 Challenges Faced

- High cost
- Time consumption
- Decision fatigue
- Risk of dissatisfaction

4.5 Seller Perspective

Businesses benefit from increased customer engagement and loyalty but face challenges such as production complexity and higher costs.

5. CASE STUDIES

5.1 Nike

Nike's customization platform allows customers to design their own products, increasing engagement and brand loyalty.

5.2 Adidas

Adidas offers personalization but faces challenges in scalability and cost management.

5.3 Zara

Zara uses consumer feedback to create trend-based designs, acting as indirect customization.

5.4 Manyavar

Manyavar provides semi-customized ethnic wear, especially for weddings, enhancing customer satisfaction.

6. Technological innovations in customization

Technological advancements have played a crucial role in transforming customization within the fashion industry. Modern tools and digital systems have made it possible for designers and brands to offer personalized clothing solutions efficiently while maintaining quality and speed. These innovations not only improve the customer experience but also help businesses streamline their operations and reduce errors.

6.1 Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Artificial Intelligence has become a powerful tool in the field of fashion customization. It helps brands understand customer preferences by analyzing data such as past purchases, browsing behavior, and style choices. Based on this information, AI can recommend designs, colors, and patterns that match individual tastes.

Additionally, AI reduces decision-making difficulty by suggesting suitable combinations, which makes the customization process easier for customers. It also assists designers in predicting trends and creating designs that align with customer demand, thereby improving efficiency and satisfaction.

6.2 3D Body Scanning

3D body scanning technology is used to capture accurate body measurements of customers in a quick and precise manner. This innovation eliminates the common problem of improper fitting in ready-made garments.

By using advanced sensors and imaging systems, 3D scanning creates a digital model of the customer's body. Designers can use this data to produce garments that fit perfectly according to individual body shapes. This not only enhances comfort but also reduces product returns and alterations.

6.3 Virtual Try-On Systems

Virtual try-on technology allows customers to see how a garment will look on them without physically wearing it. This is usually done through mobile applications or websites using augmented reality (AR).

Customers can select different styles, colors, and designs and instantly visualize the outcome. This helps them make better decisions and reduces uncertainty about the final product. Virtual try-on systems also improve online shopping experiences, making customization more convenient and interactive.

6.4 Digital Design Platforms

Digital design platforms provide users with tools to create and modify clothing designs in real time. These platforms allow customers to choose fabrics, colors, patterns, and styles according to their preferences.

Such systems are user-friendly and often include visual previews, which help customers understand how the final product will appear. For designers, these platforms simplify the design process, reduce manual work, and enable faster communication with clients.

7. Findings and discussion

The analysis of the collected data provides meaningful insights into how customization is perceived and adopted in the fashion industry. The findings highlight both the opportunities and challenges associated with personalized fashion from the perspectives of consumers as well as businesses.

7.1 Consumer Preference for Customization

The study indicates that a large proportion of respondents show a clear preference for customized clothing over ready-made garments. This trend reflects a growing shift in consumer mindset, where individuals seek products that align closely with their personal style and identity. Customization is especially popular for special occasions such as weddings, parties, and important events.

7.2 Key Motivating Factors

The research identifies several important reasons behind the increasing demand for customization:

- **Better Fit:** Many consumers experience dissatisfaction with standard sizes, making customized clothing a preferred option for improved comfort and accuracy in fitting.
- **Uniqueness:** Consumers value the ability to own exclusive designs that are not commonly available in the market.
- **Self-Expression:** Fashion is increasingly being used as a medium to express personality, preferences, and individuality.
- **Influence of Social Media:** Online platforms and influencers encourage consumers to experiment with personalized styles.

These factors show that customization fulfills both functional needs (fit and comfort) and emotional needs (identity and uniqueness).

7.3 Willingness to Pay

The findings suggest that a significant number of consumers are willing to spend extra on customized products. This indicates that customization is perceived as a premium service. However, a considerable portion of respondents still remains price-sensitive, which means affordability continues to play an important role in decision-making.

7.4 Challenges Faced by Consumers

Despite its advantages, customization is not free from limitations. The study highlights the following common issues:

- **Higher Cost:** Customized garments often involve additional design and labor expenses.

- **Longer Waiting Time:** The production process takes more time compared to ready-made clothing.
- **Decision Complexity:** Too many choices can confuse customers and make the process overwhelming.
- **Uncertainty of Outcome:** Some consumers hesitate due to the risk that the final product may not meet expectations.

7.5 Business Perspective

From the seller's point of view, customization offers several strategic benefits. It helps brands differentiate themselves in a competitive market and build stronger relationships with customers. Personalized products increase customer engagement and loyalty, leading to repeat purchases.

However, businesses also face operational challenges, including:

- Managing flexible production systems
- Maintaining efficiency with varied designs
- Dependence on skilled labor
- Higher operational costs

7.6 Overall Interpretation

The findings clearly indicate that customization is becoming an important part of modern fashion. It adds value to the customer experience and creates opportunities for businesses to stand out. However, its success depends on maintaining a balance between personalization and practicality.

8. Recommendations

Based on the findings of the study, several practical suggestions can be made for both businesses and consumers to improve the effectiveness and experience of customization in fashion designing.

8.1 Recommendation's for Businesses

1. Using New Technology Fashion brands and designers should use technology like artificial intelligence and digital design tools. These tools help make mistakes when making clothes and accessories. They also help designers understand what customers like. This technology can make work easier. Help people customise things easily.

2. Making It Easy To Customise It is good to give people choices. Too many choices can be confusing. Companies should give people a simple choices that are easy to understand. When people get help, with customising they can make decisions faster. Fashion brands and designers should use cutting-edge technology to make customisation easy.

3. Making The Supply Chain Better When people can customise things companies need to be able to make and deliver them quickly. Fashion brands and designers need to make their supply chain systems better. This means they can make things faster and deliver them on time. When companies do this customers are happy. Trust them more. Using technology like virtual visualisation systems can also help fashion brands and designers make the supply chain better.

8.2 Recommendations for Consumers

1. Careful Planning of Customization Consumers should take time to clearly understand their needs, preferences, and purpose before opting for customization. Planning in advance helps in making better design choices and avoids unnecessary confusion during the process.

2. Balancing Cost and Preferences Since customized products are often more expensive than ready-made garments, consumers should maintain a balance between their desired design and budget. Making practical choices can help in achieving satisfaction without overspending.

9. Future scope

The concept of customization in fashion designing is still evolving and offers significant opportunities for future research and development. With rapid technological advancements and changing consumer behavior, the scope of personalization in fashion is expected to expand further in the coming years. This section highlights key areas where future studies can contribute to a deeper understanding and improvement of customization practices.

9.1 AI-Based Customization

One of the most promising areas for future research is the use of artificial intelligence in fashion customization. Artificial Intelligence has the potential to really change how customised apparel is made and delivered. Future research can look at how Artificial Intelligence algorithms can be used to understand what customers want

like what they have bought before their body measurements and what is popular in fashion. We can use Artificial Intelligence to make systems that suggest designs based on what a person likes. This would make it easier for customers to decide what they want because they would not be confused by many options. Artificial Intelligence tools can also help designers figure out what will be popular in fashion next and make sure that the right products are made for customers. The use of Artificial Intelligence to automate the design and production process is also very important. Businesses can save money save time and make mistakes by using Artificial Intelligence with their manufacturing systems. Future studies can look at how medium-sized fashion companies can use Artificial Intelligence in a way that is affordable, for them. Artificial Intelligence can really help these companies. That is why it is so important to keep studying Artificial Intelligence and its uses in the fashion industry specifically in the creation of customised apparel.

9.2 Virtual Fashion and Digital Clothing

Virtual fashion is an emerging concept that has gained attention with the rise of digital platforms and online environments. Virtual fashion is about clothes that people can wear in environments like social media, gaming platforms or digital avatars but these clothes only exist in digital form.

The idea of customising fashion is something that can be looked into in the future. In the future people might be able to create their own digital outfits and use them when they talk to others online. This means that people do not have to worry about making clothes and it gives them more options to make their clothes special.

Also virtual fashion can help the environment because it uses resources. Researchers can look into how the fashion industry can be more eco-friendly and reduce waste by using clothes.

Another important thing is combining try-on technology with customisation platforms. Future research can look into how advanced simulation tools can make customers more confident and accurate when they shop online.

10. CONCLUSION

The way clothes are made, sold and bought has changed a lot in times and customisation in fashion design is a big part of this change. The old way of making clothes, where everything was the same and made in quantities is being replaced by a more flexible approach that focuses on what the customer wants. This change is

happening because of technology changing consumer expectations and the growing importance of being unique in fashion.

The study clearly shows that customisation has an impact on how people buy clothes. Nowadays people do not just buy any clothes; they want clothes that fit them well match their style and make them stand out. People are looking for clothes that're comfortable and unique and customisation is becoming more popular because of this.

Customisation has benefits for the customer. It makes people feel more connected to the product because they get to be a part of the design process. This makes people happy and proud of what they have made. It gives them a sense of ownership. Customised clothes also solve the problem of clothes not fitting well which makes them a good option for many people.

However the study also points out some problems that people face. Customisation can be expensive which can make it hard for people who're on a budget. It can also take longer to make and deliver clothes, which can be less convenient than buying ready-made clothes. Sometimes having many design options can be confusing and make it hard to make a decision.

Customisation can be both good and bad for businesses. On the one hand it helps businesses stand out in a market and build stronger relationships with customers. Customised products make customers come back and stay loyal to the brand. On the hand customisation can be challenging for businesses but it can also help them engage with customers and create a unique brand identity.

8. SUGGESTIONS

Based on what the study found there are some suggestions that can help make customisation in fashion design more effective. These suggestions are meant to help both businesses and customers by making the experience and solving current problems.

Suggestions for Companies

One of the important things for fashion businesses is to use modern technology. This includes tools like intelligence, digital design software and virtual visualisation systems, which can help businesses understand

what customers want and make precise customised products. These technologies can also increase productivity. Reduce design and production mistakes, which makes customers happier.

Another suggestion is to make the customisation process simpler. While giving customers a lot of options is a thing too many options can be overwhelming and make it hard for them to decide. Businesses should create a system that's easy to use and guides customers through the customisation process step by step. Offering -made combinations and design recommendations can make the process more enjoyable and convenient.

It is also important for businesses to make their supply chain more efficient. Since customised products require flexibility in production businesses need to make sure their manufacturing and delivery systems are well-organised. Faster production schedules and reliable delivery services can increase customer trust. Encourage repeat business. Businesses should also consider using production models to handle small and varied orders.

Businesses should also invest in training programs and skilled workers. Customisation often requires design and tailoring skills and hiring experienced professionals can greatly improve the quality of the final product. Consistent quality is key, to building a brand reputation.

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